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Envy Smile Dental Spa
718-891-0606

FEATURED STORY

More Than a Cleaning: What Your Dental Hygienist Actually Does

Every year during Dental Hygienist Week, we take a moment to recognize the professionals who are, in many ways, the front line of your oral health. At Envy Smile Dental Spa, your hygienist is not simply the person who cleans your teeth before the doctor comes in. They are licensed clinician with specialized training, a thorough eye, and a direct impact on your long-term health.

To become a licensed dental hygienist, a clinician must complete a two- to four-year accredited program covering anatomy, pharmacology, radiology, periodontology, and clinical technique — followed by national and state board examinations. The credential is not a certificate course. It is a clinical degree.

At every hygiene visit, your hygienist is doing several things at once:

- **Scaling and debridement** — using precise instruments to remove calculus and biofilm from surfaces that your toothbrush and floss cannot physically reach, including below the gumline where gum disease originates.
- **Periodontal assessment** — measuring the depth of the pockets around each tooth to track whether your gum tissue is healthy, receding, or inflamed. A one-millimeter change can be clinically significant, and your hygienist notices it.
- **Oral cancer screening** — checking the soft tissues of your mouth, throat, and neck at every comprehensive visit. Early detection makes an enormous difference in outcomes.
- **Personalized home care coaching** — not generic advice, but specific guidance based on what she observes in your mouth that day: your brushing technique, your flossing habits, the areas you consistently miss.

This is why the hygiene appointment matters even when nothing feels wrong. Prevention, done consistently, is what keeps small problems from becoming large ones.

TEAM SPOTLIGHT

Meet the Envy Smile Hygiene Team

The hygienists at Envy Smile are not just skilled clinicians: they are people who genuinely care, inside the office and out. Here is a little about the team behind your cleanings.

Kerrie brings 25 years of experience in dentistry to every appointment, and it shows. Patients often comment that she notices things no one else has caught, asks the right questions, and takes the time to explain what she is seeing and why it matters. Two and a half decades in this field means she has seen nearly everything, and her depth of knowledge is the kind that only comes from doing this work, carefully, for a very long time.

Banny splits his time between two jobs that have more in common than you might think. When he is not caring for your teeth at Envy Smile, he is a firefighter: someone people call when they need help and trust completely. That same calm, steady reliability that makes a good firefighter makes a great hygienist, and Banny brings it to every patient he sees.

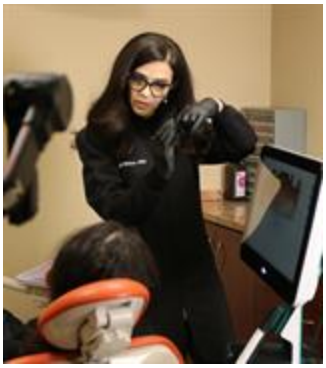
Gamaella is our newest addition in more ways than one; she recently became a mom, and anyone who has spent five minutes with her knows that the same attentiveness and patience she brings to her baby comes with her to work every day. There is something about a new parent's focus and care that translates beautifully into how she treats patients, and her chair is one of the most relaxed in the office.

What Dr. Weiner looks for when building her hygiene team goes beyond clinical credentials. "I want someone who genuinely listens to patients," she says. "Clinical skill is the foundation, but the ability to explain, to reassure, and to build trust over years of visits is what makes a great hygienist."

The result is a hygiene experience that feels thorough without feeling rushed, and personalized rather than procedural. Our team knows your history, notices your patterns, and cares about your results.

A NOTE FROM DR. WEINER

Why I Built My Practice Around a Great Hygiene Team



"Prevention is the most powerful tool I have as a dentist. And the hygienist is the one who delivers it, visit after visit."
– Dr. Marianna Weiner, Envy Smile Dental Spa

When I was designing this practice, I knew that the hygiene department would define the patient experience more than almost anything else. Most patients see their hygienist twice a year. They see me at every visit too — but the hygienist is the constant, the relationship, the person who knows how your gums looked six months ago and notices when something has changed.

Investing in the right team was not optional. It was the foundation.

To our hygienists: thank you for the precision, the patience, and the genuine care you bring to every appointment. Dental Hygienist Week is one week, but the work you do matters every single day.

— Dr. Marianna Weiner, DDS

ALSO IN THIS ISSUE

Five Signs You Are Overdue for a Cleaning

It is easy to put off a routine cleaning when nothing hurts. But your mouth gives signals long before discomfort sets in. Here is what to watch for:

- **Gums that bleed when you brush or floss** — this is not normal, and it is not caused by brushing too hard. Bleeding gums are almost always a sign of inflammation, and inflammation is the earliest stage of gum disease. It is also the most reversible.
- **Persistent bad breath** — when regular brushing does not fix it, the source is usually below the gumline: bacteria in periodontal pockets that no amount of mouthwash can reach.
- **Visible buildup or discoloration along the gumline** — calculus (hardened tartar) appears as a yellowish or brown deposit at the base of the teeth. Once it hardens, it cannot be removed at home.
- **Teeth that feel rough or fuzzy** — a clean tooth feels smooth. A biofilm-coated tooth does not. If your teeth feel coated even after brushing, it is time for a professional cleaning.
- **It has been more than six months** — the most common reason, and the simplest to fix. Most patients need cleaning every six months; some with gum disease every three to four.

The good news: hygiene visits take about an hour. The problems they prevent can take much longer — and cost significantly more — to fix.

Book your hygiene appointment today and say thank you to your hygienist.

Call us: (718) 891-0606 | envysmile.com

Envy Smile Dental Spa | Dr. Marianna Weiner, DDS | (718) 891-0606 | envysmile.com

Request an Appointment

or call our office today to learn more

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